

TAB 36



Board of Education Report

File #: Res-077-24/25, **Version:** 1**Agenda Date:** 5/13/2025**In Control:** Board of Education

Ms. Newbill - Recognizing May 2025 as National Foster Care Youth Awareness Month (Res-077-24/25)
(Waiver of Board Rule 72)

Whereas, May is National Foster Care Youth Awareness Month, intended to raise awareness about the needs of children and youth in the foster care system;

Whereas, In 2024, there were approximately 46,000 students in California's foster care system who often face significant barriers to academic success, including school instability, chronic absenteeism, and higher rates of suspension and expulsion.

Whereas, Youth in foster care experience rates of homelessness ranging from 11 to 38 percent, disproportionately higher than the general population;

Whereas, During the 2024-2025 school year, Los Angeles Unified School District had students from preschool to post-high school in the foster care system;

Whereas, Half of all children in foster care have endured four or more adverse childhood experiences such as abuse, neglect, and abandonment, which can negatively affect their health and development;

Whereas, Organizations across the nation have declared May as Foster Care Youth Awareness Month to recognize resource parents (also known as foster parents), relative/nonrelative caregivers, volunteers, mentors, advocates, child welfare representatives, and others within the community and to increase awareness of the urgent needs of children and youth in foster care;

Whereas, Students in foster care are identified as a unique student population under the Local Control Funding Formula and Local Control and Accountability Plan due to being among the lowest academically achieving groups in California;

Whereas, Older students in foster care often face housing and food insecurities, challenges that have been exacerbated by the lasting residual effects of the COVID-19 pandemic, including disruptions in access to stable resources and support networks, underscoring the ongoing and urgent need for comprehensive and personalized assistance;

Whereas, The Los Angeles Unified School District Student Health & Human Services provides services to students in the foster care system, including Know Your Rights cards, Foster Youth Achievement Program, college counseling, support with school transitions, and access to conferences and career fairs, and ensures the educational rights of foster youth are honored; now, therefore, be it

Resolved, That the Governing Board of the Los Angeles Unified School District hereby declares May 2025 as Foster Care Youth Awareness Month and recognizes the unique needs of children in foster care

File #: Res-077-24/25, **Version:** 1**Agenda Date:** 5/13/2025**In Control:** Board of Education

and the ongoing importance of empowering students in foster care by emphasizing the need for community-wide efforts to provide holistic support, strengthen connections and create pathways for educational and personal success.